require building infrastructure within India and connecting it to the neighbouring countries. That would be a long-term endeavour requiring consistent investment and policy support. Further, for this connectivity to actualize, a South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation (SAARC) agreement along these lines would be needed. That is still a long way away. In November 2014, the inking of the SAARC connectivity agreements, including the motor vehicles pact, was stalled as Pakistan asked for time arguing 'it was yet to complete its internal process'.[6] Seven months later, in June 2015, India, Nepal, Bhutan and Bangladesh signed a Motor Vehicles Agreement 'for the regulation of passenger, personnel and cargo vehicular traffic'.[7] India is thus trying to build connectivity with its neighbours even if Pakistan remains unwilling to cooperate. New Delhi believes that sooner or later Islamabad will understand that if it doesn't participate it will be left out.

On Modi's first trip to Bangladesh in June 2015, the two countries resolved their boundary dispute by signing the Land Boundary Agreement (LBA) that had been negotiated for four decades. Agreements were also signed on cooperation in maritime safety, curbing human trafficking and checking counterfeit Indian currency allegedly circulated by Pakistan's intelligence service through Bangladesh. India offered Bangladesh $2 billion in line of credit and the two countries agreed to set up special economic zones(SEZs). Dhaka also promised to adopt a policy of 'zero tolerance' against terrorists and insurgents operating in India's north-east.[8]

India's relations with Afghanistan have also deepened. In December 2015, Modi inaugurated the new building of the Afghan parliament in Kabul that was constructed with Indian aid. In his address to the Afghan parliament Modi referred to ties with Afghanistan as 'timeless' and 'ancient', and pointed out that 'in the shifting contours of history, there were times we have been one. There were times we saw wars. But, through the ages, we have always enriched one another.' Emphasizing strategic